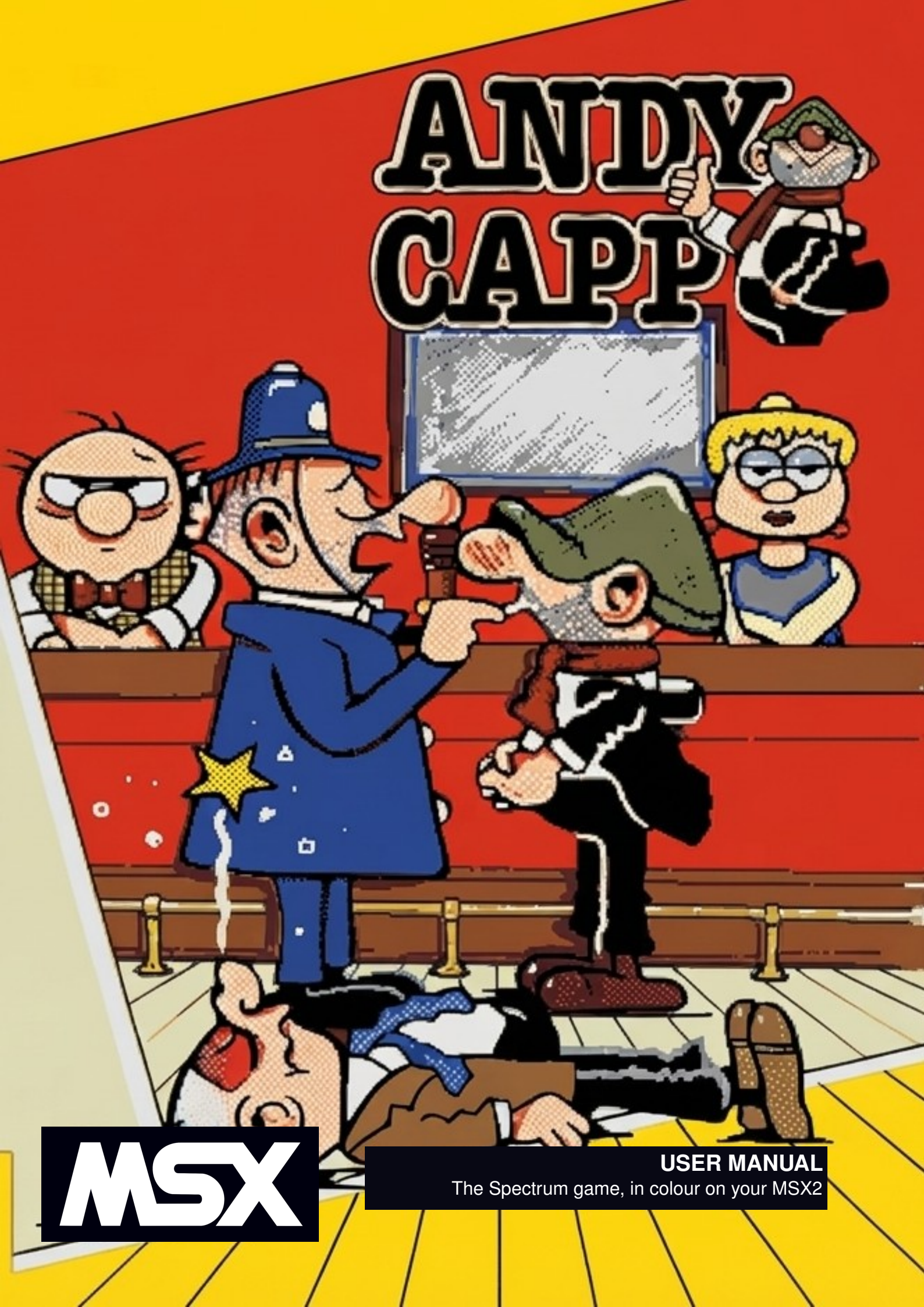


MSX

USER MANUAL

The Spectrum game, in colour on your MSX2

ANDY CAPP

for MSX2

MSX 2

An original game by **Mirrorsoft**, 1987.
MSX2 version by **DiHalt Studio**, 2026.



This is an unofficial version made for study, preservation and as a homage.

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1. What you need

Item	Requirement
Computer	**Any MSX2** (or MSX2+ or turbo R) with a free cartridge slot. It works at 50 and at 60 Hz, and the game runs at the same speed on both.
Memory	**64 KB of RAM** and **128 KB of VRAM** (the usual amount on an MSX2).
Video	The MSX2's own video chip (V9938 or V9958), in SCREEN 5. No video cartridge is needed.
Sound	The MSX PSG: the music (title and game) and the sound effects.
Game	The **Andy Capp cartridge for MSX2**: a 512 KB ASCII16 MegaROM (the file `andycapp.rom`, written to a flash cartridge or similar).
Monitor	The MSX's monitor or television.
Controls	Cursor keys and the space bar, or a joystick in port 1 or port 2.

No tape, no disk, no password. The whole game is in the cartridge.

2. Setting up

1. **Switch the MSX off.** Never insert or remove a cartridge while the computer is on.
2. Insert the **Andy Capp cartridge** in a cartridge slot.
3. Connect the monitor or television as usual.
4. Plug a joystick into port 1 or port 2 if you want to use one.
5. Switch the MSX on. After the computer's own start-up, the DiHalt Studio logo appears.

If the screen stays black, check that the cartridge is properly inserted and that the computer is an MSX2 with 64 KB of RAM. In an emulator such as openMSX, load the ROM with the **ASCII16** mapper (option `-romtype ASCII16`).

With a MegaFlashROM SCC+ SD: copy the contents of the `dist` folder to the root of the SD card (the game as `ANDYCAPP.ROM`, the `OPFXSD` program, the files to start from the card and an `AUTOEXEC.BAT`) and switch the MSX on: the game is written to the cartridge in a few seconds and starts. From then on the cartridge starts Andy Capp every time you switch on. To start from the card, hold **ESC** while switching on (also the first time, if the cartridge already had another game written in it); `OPFXSD /C` erases the game from the cartridge.

3. From power-on to the game

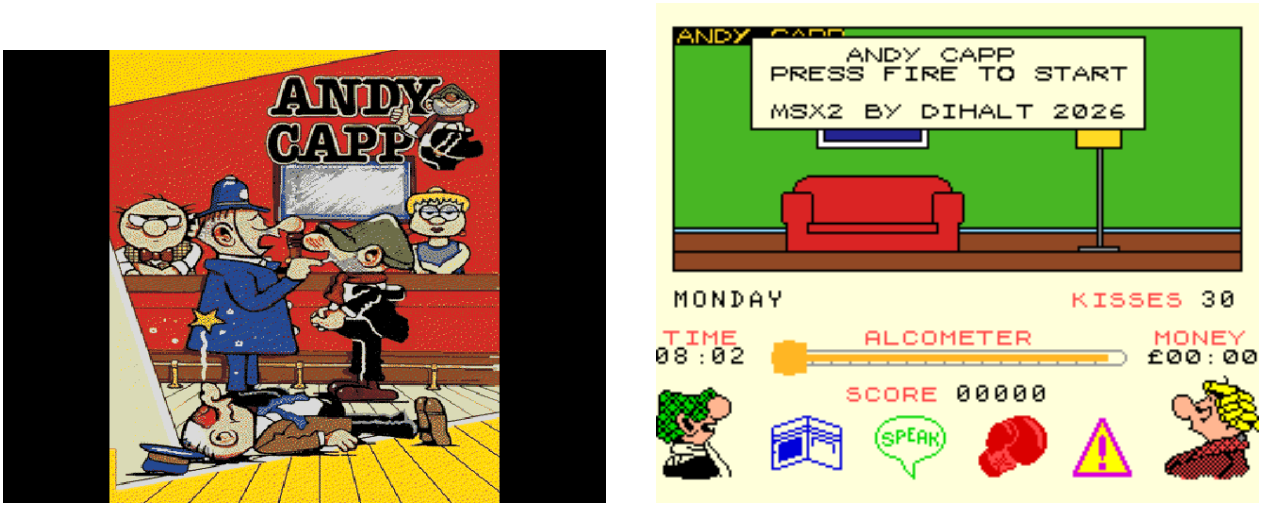


Figure 1: Left: the cover screen. Right: the title screen.

1. **DiHalt Studio logo.** About 4 seconds. It cannot be skipped.
2. **Cover.** The original box art on the whole screen. It stays until you press **any key** or move or press the **joystick** in either port.
3. **Title.** After a couple of seconds of black screen while the game loads, Andy's front room with the sign `ANDY CAPP / PRESS FIRE TO START / MSX2 BY DIHALT 2026`. The music starts (Dvořák's New World Symphony) while the alcometer fills up. Press **SPACE** or the joystick button to start.
4. **The game.** Monday, 08:00, in the front room at home, with £9.50 and 30 kisses. The music keeps playing during the game.

When the game ends (won or lost), you are back at the title screen to start another one.

4. Controls

Action	Keyboard	Joystick
Walk left / right	← →	left / right
Go through a door or turn a corner	↑	up
Blow a kiss	↓	down
Open the icon bar	**SPACE**	button (either of the two)
In the bar: choose an icon / confirm	← → / **SPACE**	left / right / button
In a menu: choose a line / confirm	↑ ↓ / **SPACE**	up / down / button
Close a message	**SPACE**	button

- To enter a building or turn a corner, **face** the door or the corner and press up: Andy turns his back and goes in.
- The joystick works in **port 1 and port 2**.

- A message stays on the screen until you press **SPACE** or the button, so you have time to read it. The clock keeps running meanwhile, and the time on the panel keeps up with it.
- There is no pause key.

5. How to play



Figure 2: Andy's street, the pub, the police station at night, the front room, the ACTION menu and a message.

It's Monday morning and you're in a flat spin. Flo's demanding your dole cheque. She'll be off to her mother's if she doesn't get it soon. And who'll do the washing-up then? You'll need every ounce of your northern wile and charm to raise the cash to survive, one way or another. Maybe you can extract a quid or two from your friends? Or try your luck on the horses? But whatever you do, steer clear of the rent man and the local copper – they're both after you with a vengeance! (from the original instructions)

The goal is to get **the giro** (the dole cheque) and give it to Flo: with the giro in your pocket, stand next to her and use it (ACTION, USE). Getting there takes a chain of errands all over town.

The town

Andy walks left and right along the streets; at the edge of the screen he goes on to the next one. At corners and at the doors of buildings, face them and press up. Two long streets are joined by side streets, with Andy's house (number 37), two *Sparkling Ales* pubs, the police station, the court, the town hall, the employment exchange, the newsagent, the betting office and Fred's factory.

Buildings have **opening hours**: the pubs open from 11:00 to 15:00 and from 17:00 to 23:00; shops and offices from Monday to Saturday, 8:00 to 17:00, and close on Sunday. At night the streets get dark.

The people

Walking around the streets are **Flo**, another **woman** with a ponytail, the **rent man** and several **policemen**. Inside the buildings there are people behind the counters: the barman, the newsagent, the clerk at the employment exchange, the police sergeant, the judge...

- To speak to or fight someone you must **be touching them**, except for the people behind a counter.
- People who are walking ignore you: first blow them a **kiss** (down). They stop for a while, stunned, and then you can talk to them. Kisses also stop a policeman so you can get away. They run out: watch the counter.

The icons

Press **SPACE** and choose one of the four icons at the bottom:

WALLET (TRANSACT) Buying and paying: a paper at the newsagent, a pint in the pub, the rent at the town hall, a bet at the betting office, an advance at the factory... What is on offer depends on where you are. Andy starts with £9.50.

SPEAK Conversation and questions: `HAVE YOU SEEN MY RENT BOOK`, `HELLO`, `HAVE YOU SEEN MY GIRO`. Some places have questions of their own (the employment exchange, the factory...).

FIGHT Sometimes getting into a scrap is the only way out. See section 7.

ACTION `INVENTORY` (what you carry), `EXAMINE` (look at an object), `USE` (use an object: drink the pint, give something to someone) and `SKIP TIME` (moves the clock on 4 hours, at the cost of a little alcohol).

Objects do not lie about on the floor: you buy them, you are given them, or you find them by doing the right thing in the right place.

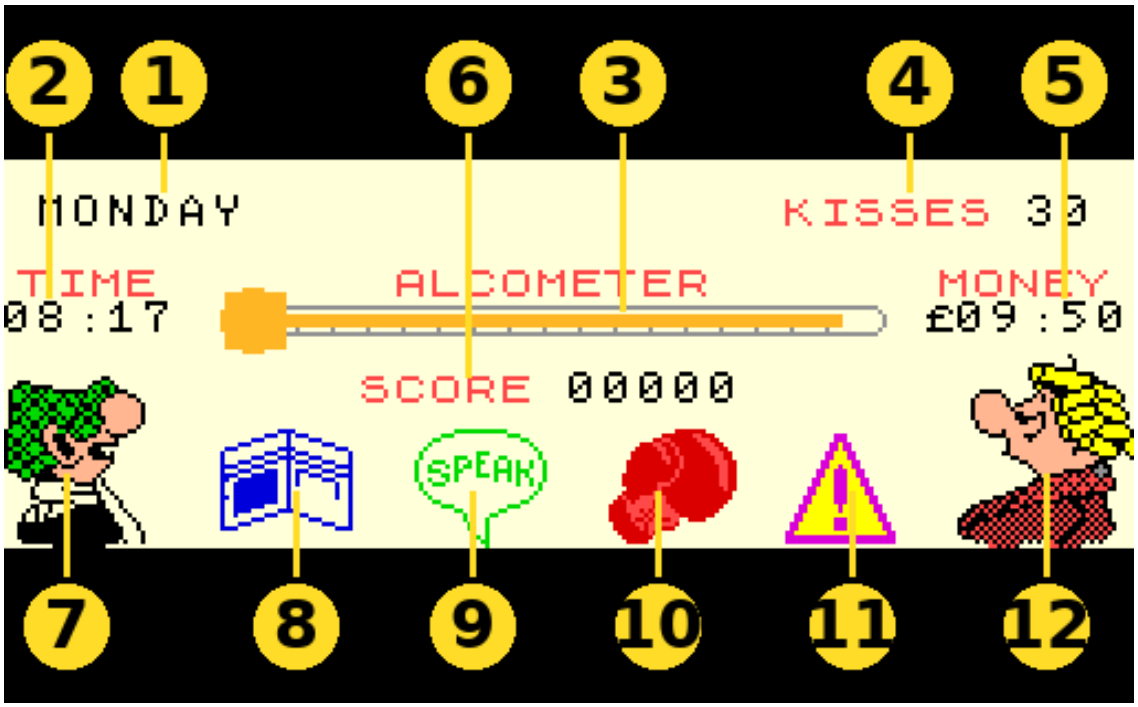
The alcometer

The alcometer bar goes down as time passes. **If it empties, the game is over.** It is topped up with a **pint**: buy it in the pub with the wallet and drink it **inside the pub** (ACTION, USE). Walk out into the street with the pint in your hand and the police are after you. When the bar is full, you have 30 kisses again.

Police, jail and the judge

Andy is **wanted** if he fights or leaves the pub with the pint. While he is wanted, a policeman who touches him takes him on in a fight (unless you stopped him with a kiss). Lose a fight and you spend the night in the cells; the next morning the judge fines you £20: if you do not pay (or cannot), the game is over.

6. The status panel



No.	Element	What it tells you
1	Day	The day of the week. It changes at midnight.
2	TIME	The time (00:00 to 23:59). A minute of game time lasts a second and a half.
3	ALCOMETER	How much drink Andy has left. If it empties, the game is over.
4	KISSES	The kisses you have left.
5	MONEY	Your money, in pounds and pence.
6	SCORE	The score: you earn it by fighting.
7	Andy	Andy Capp.
8	Wallet	TRANSACT icon: buying and paying.
9	SPEAK	The speak icon.
10	Glove	The fight icon.
11	Sign	ACTION icon: objects and SKIP TIME. The chosen icon flashes.
12	Flo	Flo, waiting for her money.

7. Scoring and the end

- The **score** only goes up by fighting: every punch Andy lands scores points, and winning a fight gives a bonus. The fight is shown as a cloud of dust; luck decides it, punch by punch. Every punch you take lowers the alcometer, every one you land raises it a little.
- **You win** when you give Flo the giro: `YOU HAVE WON` appears.
- **You lose** if the alcometer empties, or if the judge fines you and you do not pay.
- There is no day limit: the week goes on until you win or lose.

8. Tips

- Keep your alcometer topped up – the necessary is available from you-know-where, but only during opening hours.
- Steer clear of the policeman – you're on the wanted list.
- If you fancy a flutter, remember you don't only get tips from the inlay card: read the racing paper.
- After all, if things get desperate, you could always get a job.
- Talk to everybody (blow a kiss first if they are walking) and ask about the giro and the rent book.
- Some people are softened by a little present.
- SKIP TIME helps you reach opening time, but it costs drink.

The first four tips are the ones of the original instructions.

9. Credits and rights

- **Andy Capp** is a game by **Mirrorsoft**, 1987. Programmed by Blitter Animations; music by Jason C. Brooke. The Andy Capp characters are creations of Reg Smythe and the property of Mirror Group Newspapers. The game, its graphics, music and name belong to their owners. This is an unofficial version made for study, preservation and as a homage; it is not affiliated with them.
- **MSX2 version** (MSX2 version: SCREEN 5 graphics engine, colour art, split palette, PSG sound, tools, logo and cover screens): **DiHalt Studio**, 2026.
- MSX is a trademark of MSX Licensing Corporation. The MSX logo is shown only to say which computers the game runs on (file `MSX-Logo.svg`, Wikimedia Commons).
- Source code available on GitHub. **Please improve the game if you feel so!**

Appendix. Cartridge label

A label for the cartridge, ready to print. At 100 % it is about 16 cm wide; scale it in your printing program to the label area of your cartridge (the picture is 3:2).

